

MAITRI

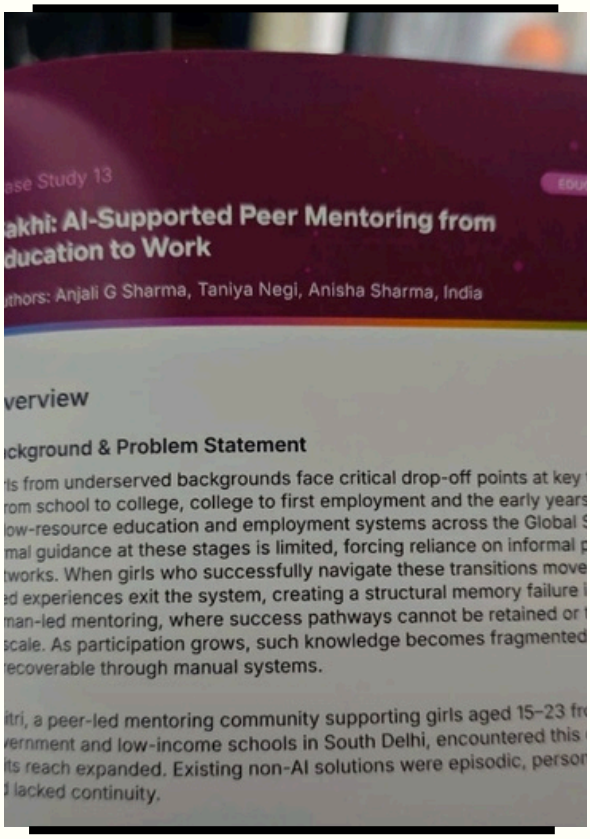
मैत्री

SISTERHOOD. COURAGE. ASPIRATIONS

JAN - MAR 2026

@maitri_aspiring_together
www.maitriaspire.org







Maitri Sakhi: AI for Equity

Proud and Humbled to share that Maitri's AI initiative, Sakhi is featured as a case study in the Casebook on AI and Gender Empowerment, launched jointly by the IndiaAI Mission, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and UN Women at the India AI Impact Summit 2026 held recently in Delhi.

As AI shapes access to opportunities, it is imperative to centre girls and women within the AI transformation-not as beneficiaries, but as active agents whose needs, realities and context inform how AI is designed and used.

The case study on Sakhi shares AI support for peer mentoring rooted in Maitri community's lived experiences and reflections thus supporting first generation learner girls navigating critical education-to-work transitions.

This thoughtful compendium of case studies from across Global South reinforces inclusive AI for gender equity where girls stand at the centre of AI solutions and no girl is left behind

It is a matter of immense pride for all of us at Maitri that our endeavour Sakhi has been selected from amongst hundreds of entries received from across Global South for using AI across health, education, skilling and more. We remain committed to using AI to support journeys of our girls towards success.

MAITRI GIRLS SHINE AT BTB WORDSMITHS AWARD 2026



Our girls Moumita, Bhavya, Arifa and Yukti represented Maitri community at the BTB Annual Awards Season 6, an evening which showcased and felicitated the work of writers from across the globe.

While Moumita and Bhavya shared about what makes us unique and the kind of sisterhood that we are passionately building, Arifa recited a self composed poem that resonated with everyone for its authenticity and depth, while Yukti performed a graceful classical dance performance set to an Indie Pop song - a stunning blend of tradition and contemporary expression. Watching them own the stage with confidence was a proud moment for all of us.

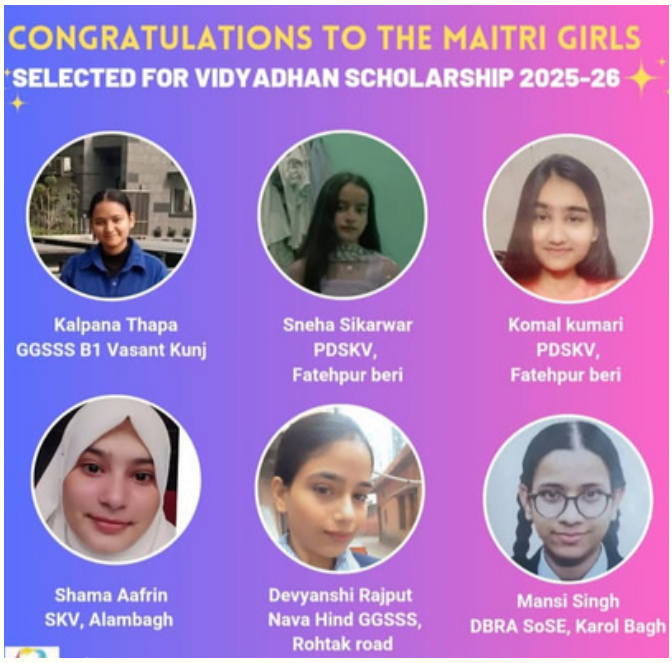
Their participation reaffirmed Maitri's resolve to provide recognized platforms for its girls to shine and gain confidence through exposure.

MAITRI STARS

VIDYADHAN FELLOWSHIP

At Maitri, we take pride in the fact how our senior girls who are past scholars support their juniors for success. In line with supporting our girls post class 10th on scholarships, six of our girls are now a recipient of presitigous Vidyadhan Fellowship 2025-26 program. This will support them with financial and mentorship help for the next 6-8 years till the end of their graduation.

The results which were announced in January showcased the immsense hard work of the girls and also dedication and sisterhood of the community. Selected post intense process of scholarship application, written, interview and home visits from amongst a pool of 500+ applicants.



WORKING WOMEN @ MAITRI





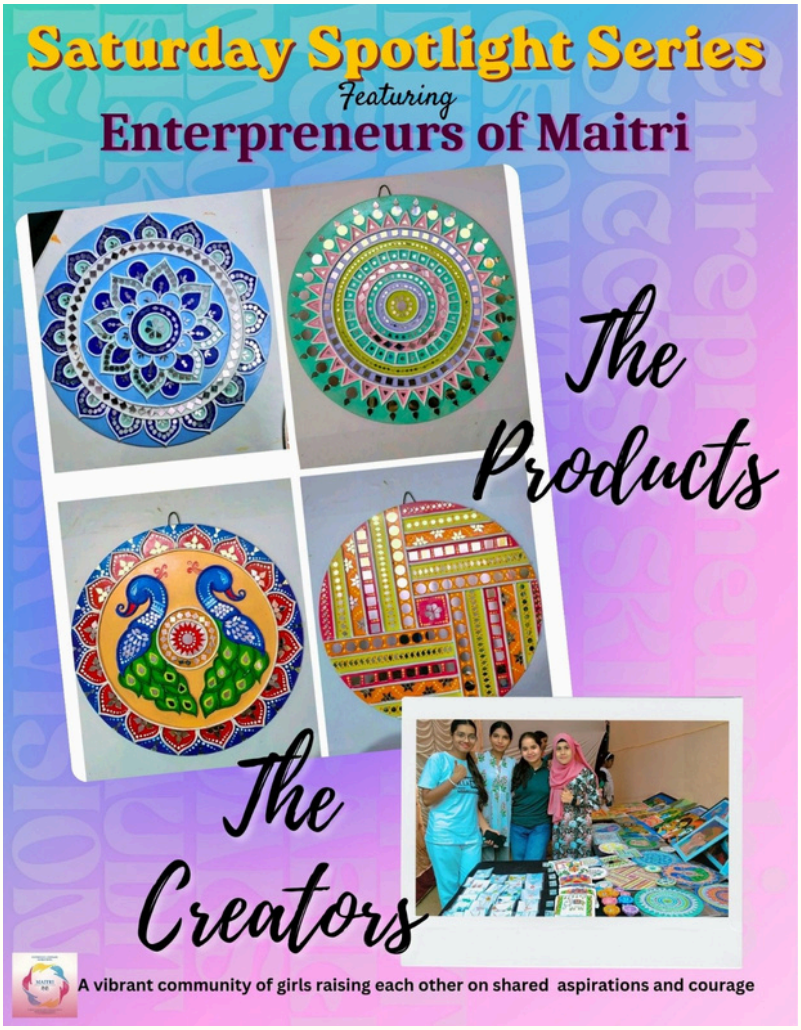
Proud to share that Nidhi and Jiya, have recently transitioned into full-time employment—marking an important milestone not just in their journeys, but for the wider Maitri community.

Nidhi has joined Ekam Analytics, a leading Bengaluru-based startup in the data and analytics space. Her placement comes after six months of rigorous internship, during which she demonstrated exceptional dedication, consistency, and a strong learning mindset.

Jiya has secured a full-time role with the Great Homestays of India Network, where she is currently working as an Assistant to the Director of Operations. Her journey stands out for its initiative and self-driven approach. Beyond their individual achievements, both Nidhi and Jiya are actively contributing back to the Maitri ecosystem. Jiya, in particular, continues to bring in new opportunities for other girls through her organization, strengthening the pathway from learning to employment.

Importantly, both organizations have expressed their intent to continue offering such opportunities in the future—creating a growing pipeline for young women from the Maitri community.

ENTERPRENEURS OF MAITRI



At Maitri, we actively encourage our girls to showcase their creations at various platforms. These opportunities not only help them gain financial support but also build their confidence and visibility.

We've also launched our Saturday Spotlight Series, where we feature our talented budding entrepreneurs and their innovative products, giving them an online space to reach a wider audience.

We started this initiative with the spotlight this week on the team of - Kangna, Aksha, Simran and Juhi, who are beautifully reviving traditional craftsmanship through their exquisite handmade Lippan art!

This stunning mirror-and-clay artwork is completely eco-friendly, highly customizable, and perfectly blends heritage with modern décor needs.

Their inspiring journey began in Class 12 as part of an EMC (Enterpreneruship Mindset Curriculum) activity, where they discovered their deep passion for creating these beautiful art pieces. With continuous support from the Maitri community, they have successfully grown their small business and are now proudly sharing their talent with the world.













Collaboration with FIIB

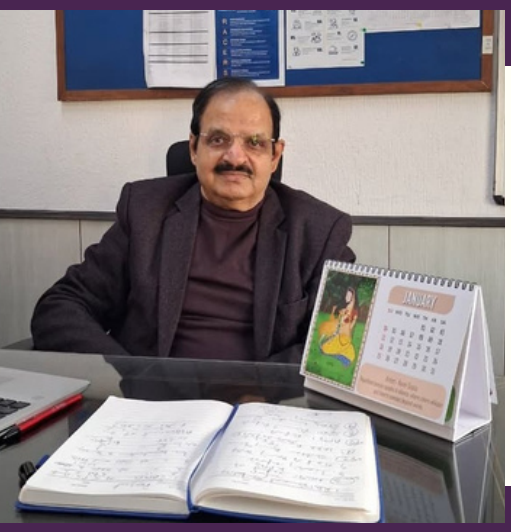
In January, we hosted first-year students from Fortune Institute of International Business (FIIB), who interned with Maitri under their Social Internship Program (SIP). Their focus areas included community interaction, marketing, and fundraising.

In one of their sessions, they began with thoughtful introduction with girls pushing them to reflect, with prompts such as “How did we join Maitri?” and “When did we begin our journey?” which encouraged participants to reflect on their individual experiences and deepen their connection with the community.

The MBA students designed and facilitated a series of engaging activities. As true champions of change and sustained community development, they spearheaded sales of Maitri 2026 calendars in their network at college, close friends and also sent proposals to corporates.

We are grateful to the FIIB students for bringing their insights, structure, and energy to the community. Their contributions have helped strengthen our community processes and opened up avenues for new collaborations and synergies.

WATCH SOME VIDEOS CREATED BY STUDENTS









MAITRI'S OUTREACH SESSIONS AT GOVT SCHOOLS

In an endeavour to expand awareness around possibilities and opportunities, the Maitri team regularly visits government girls' schools.

During these sessions, past scholars—often from the same school—return to interact with younger students. Through their journeys and experiences, they motivate juniors to aspire higher, pursue opportunities beyond immediate constraints, and reimagine what is possible for themselves.

These peer-led interactions create a powerful sense of relatability and belief, as students see role models who have walked the same paths and successfully moved forward. Multiple such sessions were conducted in January and February, strategically timed just before the board examinations, to encourage and motivate girls to approach their exams with confidence and ambition.









ADOPT A JOURNEY,
AND SUPPORT THE CAUSE

Maitri is building a powerful ecosystem where young women from underserved backgrounds transition from aspiration to achievement through peer-led mentorship, leadership development, and access to opportunities. In the past year alone, our community has grown to more than 500 members, with over 30 girls securing employment and close to 150 accessing scholarships and higher education pathways. What makes Maitri unique is its multiplier effect—every girl who rises becomes a mentor, opening doors for others.

Come join us in this mission by enabling scholarships, skills, laptops, internships, and job opportunities to unlock the full potential of many more young women. Follow our Insta handle

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PICS FROM INDIA AI IMPACT SUMMIT 2026

MAITRI'S AI INITIATIVE SAKHI HAS BEEN FEATURED IN CASEBOOK ON REAL-WORLD IMPACT OF AI IN GENDER EMPOWERMENT LAUNCHED AT THE SUMMIT BY MS. CHRISTINE ARAB (REGIONAL DIRECTOR, UN WOMEN ASIA AND THE PACIFIC)

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